

Barclays

Barclays is a British multinational banking and financial services company headquartered in London, with a rich history dating back to 1690. It operates globally, providing a wide range of banking, investment, and wealth management services to individuals, businesses, and institutions. With a significant presence in the United Kingdom and an international footprint, Barclays offers retail and corporate banking, investment banking, asset management, and credit card services. The bank has been involved in various philanthropic initiatives and is known for its commitment to sustainability and environmental practices.

There were 3 rounds namely:

- **Round 1: Online Assessment (Virtual)**
 - This round mainly focused on fundamentals of Software Engineering(SDLC lifecycle), OOPS, DBMS, finding outputs of c/cpp/Java codes, debugging programs, and Aptitude questions.
 - There were a total of 25 MCQs and 5 sql queries to be completed within 70 minutes.
 - The test was conducted on the Hacker Earth Platform.
 - Note: Out of around 400 students who applied for attempting the OA, only around 200 were shortlisted for writing the test.
 - 46 students proceeded further for the interview process conducted at CUIC.
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- **Round 2: Technical Interview (@ CUIC)**
 - This round started off with a brief introduction about myself, and I moved on to explain about the project that I was most proud of, since I worked really hard to deploy it as well.
 - The interviewer asked me why I chose MERN Stack and why MongoDB over SQL. (I explained the difference between vertical and horizontal scaling here)
 - The interviewer was interested in knowing every nook and corner of how I did the project and how I managed to deploy it within a month.
 - She asked me what motivated me to take up the projects I invested my time in.
 - What were the key challenges I faced during my projects.
 - Major/Key Take-aways and Learnings made .
 - She asked me to give a brief explanation about Gen AI, since I mentioned the certification (as part of our Naan Mudhalvan Syllabus) in my resume
 - Difference between GPT-5 and GPT-4 , which I couldn't answer properly, but managed to give some convincing differences.

- What Data Structure is used in your phone gallery app? With reference to how you can easily scroll the pictures in your gallery without having to wait for each picture to load. Explain your choice.
 - Finally, she asked why I chose to study in CEG and how these 2 years have changed me.
 - This round lasted for **1 hour and 15 mins**
 - **25 students** proceeded for the HR round.
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- **Round 3: HR Round (@ CUIC)**

- This round was entirely behavioural, where the interviewer presented me with various scenarios to assess my crisis management skills and my response in critical situations. Some questions include:
 - She asked me to elaborate on my hobbies, as I had mentioned them in my resume.
 - Where do you see yourself in the next 4 years?
 - Imagine your team is going to release/deploy a project tomorrow. Today night you realise that there is a bug in the code and that it was you who made the mistake of creating the bug. What will you do?
 - Microsoft or Barclays?
 - Materialistic life or Work-Balance life?
 - Finally, she asked basic details about my parents and this round ended within **20 minutes**.
 - Out of 25 students, **15 students (5 from our dept)** were selected for the 2026 Summer Internship Programme at Barclays and I was lucky to be a part of it.
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- **Some Tips**

- Be confident while answering the questions.
- Be truthful to your resume. You must be thorough with every nook and corner of your resume, especially your projects.
- Have a habit of solving DSA problems, and revising DBMS / OOPS concepts regularly.
- In Barclays interviews many were asked on concepts like ER Diagram, Normalization, etc.
- Try to maintain a CGPA of about 8+ , if otherwise, focus on other projects to compensate.
- Read the job description and you must do a research about the company.
- Refer to the company's website to learn about RISES.

- **A little intro about myself**

- Looking back, I realize I didn't fully utilize my summer holidays. I did practice a few easy-to-medium problems on LeetCode now and then, but even after receiving this offer, I can clearly see that my problem-solving skills still have a long way to go.
 - Most of my time went into working on projects, while I also made sure to spend some leisure moments with my family.
 - The seriousness of internship preparation struck me only when internship offers started flooding the CUIC WhatsApp group—it was a wake-up call.
 - In the end, I managed to make good use of the time I had during the final stretch, but if there's one piece of advice I'd give, it would be to start preparing early, ideally from your 3rd or 4th semester itself.
 - I was shortlisted for interviews at Appian and Western Digital (the latter being heavily focused on C programming, which wasn't my strong area), but my preparation at that stage wasn't sufficient to clear them.
 - Barclays was my 3rd glow of hope, and I was determined to grab that opportunity.
 - All the very best for your future internship opportunities!!
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- **Contact**

- Feel free to reach out to me, I'll be more than happy to help you in whatever way I can!
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